

Supply Chain and Logistics English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: supply-chain managers, planners, buyers, logistics coordinators, warehouse leaders, procurement teams, customs staff, and operations managers

Focus: A supply-chain English curriculum for forecasting, shortages, purchasing, inventory, warehouse operations, logistics delays, supplier performance, customs, risk, and crisis communication.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Demand Planning and Forecast Bias

Situation

Sales raises the forecast after a promotion begins.

Stakeholder pressure: Increase production commitments immediately.

Constraint: Forecast bias, lead time, capacity, and inventory exposure need review.

Terms to use

- forecast
- forecast bias
- demand signal
- S&OP

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Sales raises the forecast after a promotion begins.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Increase production commitments immediately.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects forecast bias.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a demand-planning exception note.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects forecast bias.

Option	Phrase
A	forecast
B	forecast bias
C	demand signal
D	S&OP

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Increase production commitments immediately.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A demand-planning exception note is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify forecast and forecast bias against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	decision owner
D	We should act now and resolve forecast after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Sales raises the forecast after a promotion begins. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the demand-planning exception note with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Module 2. Procurement and Supplier Performance

Situation

A supplier misses delivery but promises recovery next week.

Stakeholder pressure: Accept the promise and update the plan.

Constraint: Capacity, allocation, purchase order terms, and recovery evidence are unclear.

Terms to use

- purchase order
- lead time
- OTIF
- allocation

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A supplier misses delivery but promises recovery next week.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Accept the promise and update the plan.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects lead time.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a supplier recovery plan.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects lead time.

Option	Phrase
A	purchase order
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Accept the promise and update the plan.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A supplier recovery plan is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	evidence threshold
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify purchase order and lead time against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A supplier misses delivery but promises recovery next week. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the supplier recovery plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Module 3. Inventory, Safety Stock, and Service Levels

Situation

Finance wants to reduce inventory across all SKUs.

Stakeholder pressure: Cut safety stock by the same percentage.

Constraint: Demand variability, lead time, margin, service level, and stockout risk differ by item.

Terms to use

- safety stock
- stockout
- service level

- SKU

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Finance wants to reduce inventory across all SKUs.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Cut safety stock by the same percentage.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects stockout.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a inventory segmentation memo.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects stockout.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	safety stock

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Cut safety stock by the same percentage.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A inventory segmentation memo is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	evidence threshold
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify safety stock and stockout against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Finance wants to reduce inventory across all SKUs. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
B	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Option	Phrase
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the inventory segmentation memo with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	decision owner

Module 4. Warehousing and Fulfillment

Situation

Orders are late because pick accuracy is falling.

Stakeholder pressure: Add overtime until backlog clears.

Constraint: Slotting, labor, scanner data, training, and error types need diagnosis.

Terms to use

- pick rate
- slotting
- cycle count
- backlog

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Orders are late because pick accuracy is falling.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Add overtime until backlog clears.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects slotting.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a fulfillment recovery update.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects slotting.

Option	Phrase
A	pick rate
B	slotting
C	cycle count
D	backlog

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Add overtime until backlog clears.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify pick rate and slotting against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	We should act now and resolve pick rate after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Orders are late because pick accuracy is falling. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the fulfillment recovery update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	approval path

Module 5. Freight, Routing, and Carrier Delays

Situation

A carrier misses pickup before a major customer shipment.

Stakeholder pressure: Blame the carrier and wait.

Constraint: Mode, route, cutoff time, expedite cost, and customer promise need a decision.

Terms to use

- incoterms
- carrier
- expedite
- ETA

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A carrier misses pickup before a major customer shipment.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Blame the carrier and wait.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects carrier.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a freight escalation notice.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects carrier.

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	carrier
C	incoterms
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Blame the carrier and wait.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	We should act now and resolve incoterms after the result is visible.
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify incoterms and carrier against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A carrier misses pickup before a major customer shipment. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the freight escalation notice with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

Module 6. Customs, Trade Compliance, and Documentation

Situation

A shipment is held because the commercial invoice has inconsistent data.

Stakeholder pressure: Ask customs to release it anyway.

Constraint: Classification, country of origin, valuation, and document consistency matter.

Terms to use

- HS code
- country of origin
- commercial invoice

- broker

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A shipment is held because the commercial invoice has inconsistent data.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Ask customs to release it anyway.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects country of origin.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a customs hold response.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects country of origin.

Option	Phrase
A	HS code
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	country of origin

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Ask customs to release it anyway.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify HS code and country of origin against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	We should act now and resolve HS code after the result is visible.
D	A customs hold response is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A shipment is held because the commercial invoice has inconsistent data. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the customs hold response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Option	Phrase
C	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Module 7. Supply Risk and Business Continuity

Situation

A port strike threatens inbound components.

Stakeholder pressure: Promise no customer impact.

Constraint: Allocation, alternate sources, inventory position, and customer priority need governance.

Terms to use

- business continuity
- dual sourcing
- allocation
- constraint

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A port strike threatens inbound components.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Promise no customer impact.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects dual sourcing.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a supply risk brief.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects dual sourcing.

Option	Phrase
A	constraint
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	business continuity

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Promise no customer impact.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A supply risk brief is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify business continuity and dual sourcing against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	We should act now and resolve business continuity after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A port strike threatens inbound components. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the supply risk brief with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
C	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Module 8. Executive S&OP Decisions

Situation

Sales, finance, and operations disagree on next quarter's plan.

Stakeholder pressure: Use the most optimistic demand view.

Constraint: The executive team must agree on assumptions, risk, upside, and owners.

Terms to use

- S&OP
- consensus plan
- scenario
- owner

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Sales, finance, and operations disagree on next quarter's plan.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Use the most optimistic demand view.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects consensus plan.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a S&OP decision summary.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects consensus plan.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	S&OP
C	owner
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Use the most optimistic demand view.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A S&OP decision summary is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	evidence threshold
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify S&OP and consensus plan against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Sales, finance, and operations disagree on next quarter's plan. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the S&OP decision summary with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	decision owner
C	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
D	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each stage after completing the practice sequence. The rationale explains the decision skill the strongest response demonstrates.

Demand Planning and Forecast Bias - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. forecast	'forecast' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Demand Planning and Forecast Bias - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify forecast and forecast bias against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Demand Planning and Forecast Bias - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the demand-planning exception note with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Procurement and Supplier Performance - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. purchase order	'purchase order' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Procurement and Supplier Performance - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify purchase order and lead time against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Procurement and Supplier Performance - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the supplier recovery plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Inventory, Safety Stock, and Service Levels - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. safety stock	'safety stock' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Inventory, Safety Stock, and Service Levels - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify safety stock and stockout against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Inventory, Safety Stock, and Service Levels - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the inventory segmentation memo with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Warehousing and Fulfillment - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. pick rate	'pick rate' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Warehousing and Fulfillment - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify pick rate and slotting against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Warehousing and Fulfillment - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the fulfillment recovery update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Freight, Routing, and Carrier Delays - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. incoterms	'incoterms' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Freight, Routing, and Carrier Delays - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify incoterms and carrier against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Freight, Routing, and Carrier Delays - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the freight escalation notice with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Customs, Trade Compliance, and Documentation - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. HS code	'HS code' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Customs, Trade Compliance, and Documentation - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify HS code and country of origin against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Customs, Trade Compliance, and Documentation - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the customs hold response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Supply Risk and Business Continuity - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. business continuity	'business continuity' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Supply Risk and Business Continuity - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify business continuity and dual sourcing against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Supply Risk and Business Continuity - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the supply risk brief with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Executive S&OP Decisions - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. S&OP	'S&OP' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Executive S&OP Decisions - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify S&OP and consensus plan against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Executive S&OP Decisions - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the S&OP decision summary with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.